

Personalized Self-Care Plan

Thomas and Morris (2017) defined self-care as “...an action that enhances mental, emotional, physical, or spiritual well-being resulting in a more holistic, balanced individual.” With this definition in mind, complete the following self-care activities and reflections.

1. Take a moment to read the following article from the American Counselor Association’s Members Blog: <https://www.counseling.org/news/aca-blogs/aca-member-blogs/aca-member-blogs/2018/04/16/identifying-and-overcoming-burnout-essential-practices-for-counselors>
 - a. Use the following spaces for personal reflections or notes on the blog:
 - i. A personal reflection I was able to make by reading this article is that I need to work on a prevention plan for burnout. New counselors tend to become overworked, and experience burn out more often. Having a plan will help prevent fatigue and future mental and physical illness caused by burn out.
 - ii. Another important factor I was made aware after reading this article was that burnout can result in symptoms of depression and anxiety, fatigue. It also comes with physical symptoms such as high blood pressure, high cholesterol, and cardiovascular problems. Seeking a counselor to talk with and look at positive outlooks is great to prevent these symptoms.
2. Wheel of Life
 - a. The eight sections in the Wheel of Life represent different aspects of your life. Place your name in the center of the wheel. If a section could be labeled better to fit an aspect of your life, change the name on the wheel. Seeing the center of the wheel as one and the outer edges as 10, rank your level of satisfaction with each life area by drawing a straight or curved line to create a new outer edge. The new perimeter represents the wheel of your life. If this were a real wheel, how bumpy would the ride be?
 - b. Alternatively, you can [complete this assessment online](#) and snip your results from the PDF provided at the end of the assessment and copy/paste them rather than providing an image in a Word file. Your options for completing this assessment are as follows: use the link above; print out the wheel of life below, fill it in by hand, and scan it; use the highlighting tools in Word.
 - c. See Figure 1.
3. Self-Care Assessment
 - a. Fill out the assessment in Figure 2.
 - b. Using Table 1, fill out information from the assessment
4. Social Support
 - a. Four types of social support have been identified (Salser, 2003; Cobb, 1976):
 - i. **Emotional support** refers to demonstrations of empathy, love, caring, and concern. It bolsters one’s self-esteem and confidence. An emotional supporter is a confidante, offering acceptance, care, and understanding.
 - ii. **Informational support** refers to assistance with knowledge, information, and skills. It can include providing information on where to find resources or teaching a skill.
 - iii. **Instrumental support** refers to concrete assistance in helping others to do things or get things done (especially stressful or unpleasant tasks).
 - iv. **Companion support** refers to companionship, feeling connected, and being with people in whose company you enjoy being, especially for recreational activities.
 - b. Using Table 2, fill out the information from the resource above.

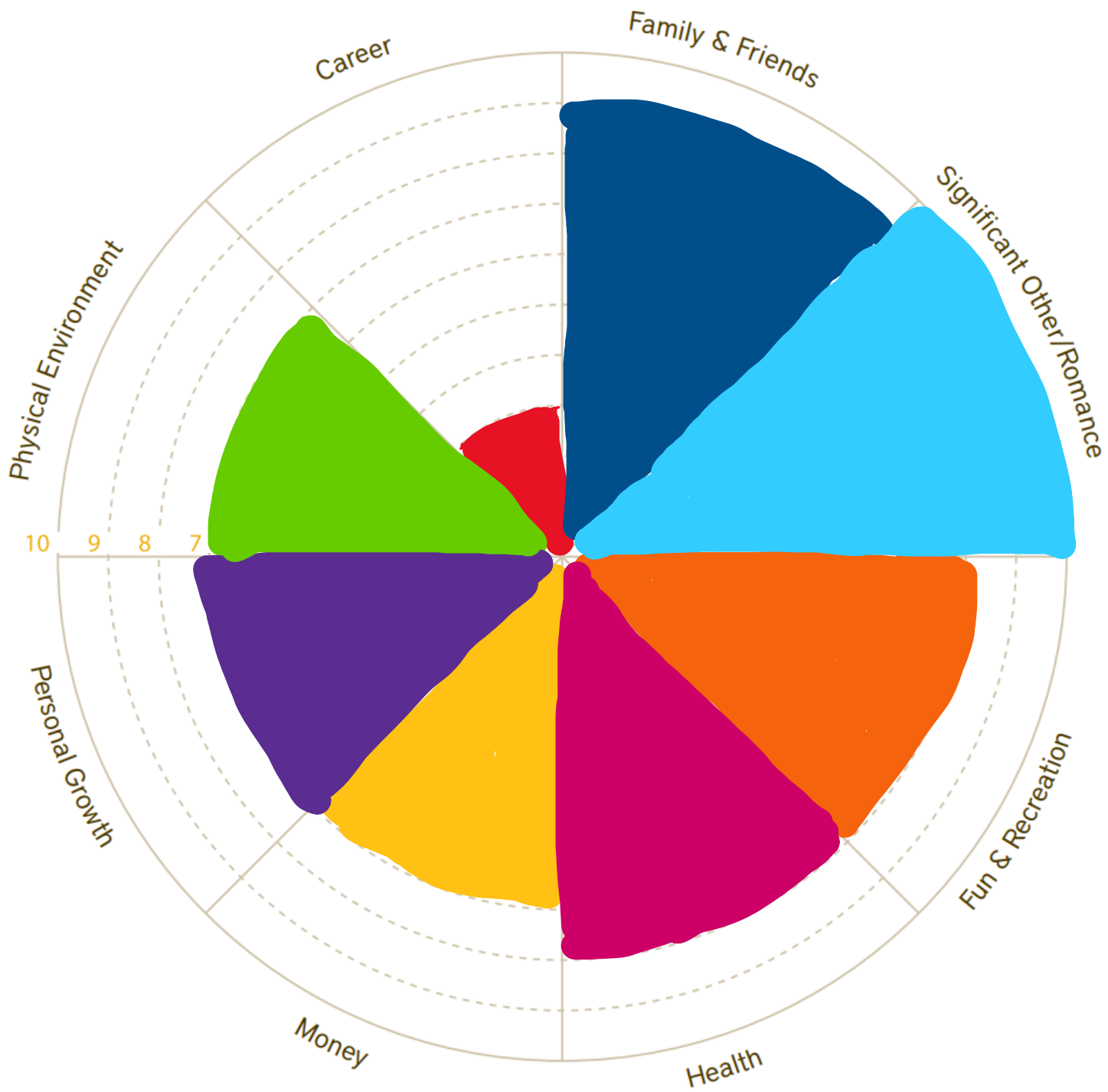


Figure 2: Using the scale below, rate the following areas in terms of frequency: 5 = Frequently, 4 = Occasionally, 3 = Rarely, 2 = Never, 1 = It never occurred to me

Physical Self-Care

- _4__ Eat Healthy, Regularly
- _3__ Exercise
- _2__ Regular Preventative Medical Care
- _4__ Time Off When Needed
- _3__ Massages
- _3__ Fun Physical Activity
- _4__ Time to Be Sexual
- _3__ Enough Sleep
- _5__ Wear Clothes You Like
- _4__ Take Vacations
- _2__ Time Away from Electronics
- ___ Other:_____

Psychological Self-Care

- _2__ Time For Self Reflection
- _1__ Personal Counseling
- _1__ Journaling
- _3__ Reading For Pleasure
- _4__ Hobbies
- _3__ Decrease Stress
- _4__ Let Others Get To Know You
- _4__ Listen To Yourself
- _3__ Intellectual Learning
- _2__ Practice Receiving From Others
- _4__ Saying No
- ___ Other:_____

Emotional Self-Care

- _5__ Spend Time With Others
- _3__ Connecting With Important People
- _3__ Affirmations About Self
- _3__ Comforting Activities
- _4__ Allowing Space For Feelings

- _5__ Time To Laugh
- _4__ Learn To Express Anger
- _5__ Play With Young Ones
- ___ Other:_____

Spiritual Self-Care

- _3__ Spend Time With Nature
- _2__ Spiritual Connection
- _3__ Finding Inspiration
- _4__ Cherishing Optimism and Hope
- _4__ Being Aware of Nonmaterial Aspects
- _4__ Try To Not Take Charge
- _4__ Openness To Not Knowing
- _3__ Identify What Is Meaningful
- _2__ Mediate
- _2__ Pray
- _5__ Sing
- _2__ Contribute to Causes
- _4__ Read Inspirational Literature
- ___ Other:_____

Professional Self-Care

- _3__ Take Breaks
- _4__ Time to Chat With Co-Workers
- _4__ Quiet Time For Tasks
- _4__ Identify Exciting Projects
- _4__ Set Limits With Clients/Colleagues
- _1__ Balance Your Caseload
- _4__ Arrange a Comfortable Workspace
- _5__ Regular Supervision
- _3__ Negotiate For Your Needs
- _4__ Have Peer Support
- _4__ Develop an Area of Professional Interest
- ___ Other:_____

Table 1:

On the chart below, list as many self-care strategies as you can. (An example is given in each area to get you started). After you have listed strategies, **highlight in green** any that you do regularly, and **highlight in yellow** any you might like to consider adding to your life.

PHYSICAL	MENTAL (INCLUDES EMOTIONAL)	SPIRITUAL	ORGANIZATIONAL
Aerobic exercise	Sharing upset feelings with a friend	Meditation	Regularly scheduled peer supervision group
Hiking	Letting yourself feel emotions	Praying	Network
Walking	Journaling	Relaxing	Attend organizations
Running	Spend time with others	Be in nature	Be a part of a community
Yoga	Laugh	Attend Church	Volunteer
Pilates	Affirmations to yourself	Retreats	
Dancing			

Exercise developed by Catherine D. Nugent, for *Replenish the Well: An Experience in Self-Care*, workshop presented at *Peer Services: A Life in the Community for Everyone*, Fifth Annual Conference of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration, Center for Substance Abuse Treatment's Recovery Community Services Program, Washington, DC, July 13, 2004.

Table 2:

Assessing Your Current Social Support

List at least three people who provide each type of social support described on the previous page. *(It is OK to put the same person in more than one area.)*

Emotional	Informational	Instrumental	Companion
Mom	Colleague Dr. Nguyen	Mom	Mom
Partner	BCBA	Partner	Partner
Sibling	Clinical Director	Coworker	Sibling
			Friend

Reflection

1. What is my goal(s) for improving my self-care? Once a week do exercise, Journal, meditate and try to network monthly.
2. What will I do to/how will I meet my goal(s)? Set a schedule for different activities that involve self-care
3. What resources do I have that will help me reach my goal(s)? LinkedIn for networking and gym membership to do exercise.
4. What resources do I need to help me reach my goal(s)? Motivation from myself and a journal to keep track of what I have achieved.
5. How will I reward myself for achieving my goal(s)? By allowing myself to go out and enjoy time with friends and family.

Weekly Self-Care To-Do List

One thing I will do this week to step out of my comfort zone: Network

How will I nurture my relationships this week? Have a phone call and connect with my loved ones.

What activities will I engage in to support my...

Physical Wellness? Gym (running, walking)

Intellectual Wellness? Reading

Emotional Wellness? Journal

Social Wellness? Spend time with friends and family.

Spiritual Wellness? Meditate and relax.